

YOGA

MIND-FIELD ARCHITECTURE → MENTAL MODIFICATIONS AND RESTRAINT → AFFLICTIONS AND KARMIC CHAIN → EIGHT-LIMBED DISCIPLINE → ABSORPTION LADDER → LORD AND DISCRIMINATIVE INSIGHT

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW

● SUBORDINATE EXTRA

● APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

MIND-FIELD ARCHITECTURE

MIND-FIELD ARCHITECTURE

DISCIPLINE OF THE MIND-FIELD (CITTA) OBJECTS

MIND-FIELD (CITTA)

CONSCIOUS WITNESS (PURUṢA) DETERMINATE INTELLECT (BUDDHI) + EGO-MAKER (AHAṂKĀRA)

THE WITNESS MISTAKES REFLECTED MENTAL STATES FOR ITSELF CORE

RESTRAINT OF MENTAL MODIFICATIONS (CITTA-VṚTTI-NIRODHA)

YOGA: DISCIPLINE OF THE MIND-FIELD (CITTA) objects → senses → mind-field (citta) → conscious witness

(puruṣa) determinate intellect (buddhi) + ego-maker (ahaṁkāra) + sensory mind (manas) bondage = the witness

mistakes reflected mental states for itself core aim → restraint of mental modifications (citta-vṛtti-nirodha)

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• YOGA: DISCIPLINE OF THE MIND-FIELD (CITTA) objects → senses → mind-field (citta) → conscious witness
• (puruṣa) determinate intellect (buddhi) + ego-maker (ahaṁkāra) + sensory mind (manas) bondage = the witness

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• mistakes reflected mental states for itself core aim → restraint of mental modifications (citta-vṛtti-nirodha)
• YOGA: DISCIPLINE OF THE MIND-FIELD (CITTA) objects → senses → mind-field (citta) → conscious witness

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• (puruṣa) determinate intellect (buddhi) + ego-maker (ahaṁkāra) + sensory mind (manas) bondage = the witness
• mistakes reflected mental states for itself core aim → restraint of mental modifications (citta-vṛtti-nirodha)

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: YOGA: DISCIPLINE OF THE MIND-FIELD (CITTA) objects → senses → mind-field (citta) → conscious witness (puruṣa) determinate intellect (buddhi) + ego-maker (ahaṁkāra) + sensory mind (manas) bondage = the witness mistakes reflected mental states for itself core aim → restraint of mental modifications (citta-vṛtti-nirodha).

01

STAGE 01

MENTAL MODIFICATIONS AND RESTRAINT

MENTAL MODIFICATIONS AND RESTRAINT

FIVE MENTAL MODIFICATIONS (CITTA-VṚTTIS) PERCEPTION/INFERENCE/TESTIMONY

MEMORY EACH MAY BE AFFLICTED OR UNAFFECTED; EVEN VALID

PROGRESSIVE RESTRAINT TRAP

RESTRAINT IS DISCIPLINED LUCIDITY, NOT UNCONSCIOUS BLANKNESS

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• FIVE MENTAL MODIFICATIONS (CITTA-VṚTTIS) perception/inference/testimony
• memory each may be afflicted or unaffected

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• even valid cognition is a modification sustained practice (abhyāsa) + dispassion (vairāgya) → progressive restraint trap: restraint is
• FIVE MENTAL MODIFICATIONS (CITTA-VṚTTIS) perception/inference/testimony

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• memory each may be afflicted or unaffected
• even valid cognition is a modification sustained practice (abhyāsa) + dispassion (vairāgya) → progressive restraint trap: restraint is

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FIVE MENTAL MODIFICATIONS (CITTA-VṚTTIS) perception/inference/testimony | error | construction | sleep | memory each may be afflicted or unaffected; even valid cognition is a modification sustained practice (abhyāsa) + dispassion (vairāgya) → progressive restraint trap: restraint is disciplined lucidity, not unconscious blankness.

02

STAGE 02

AFFLICTIONS AND KARMIC CHAIN

AFFLICTIONS AND KARMIC CHAIN

IGNORANCE (AVIDYĀ)

EGO-IDENTIFICATION (ASMITĀ)

ATTACHMENT (RĀGA)

AVERSION (DVEṢA)

CLINGING TO LIFE (ABHINIVEŚA) AFFLICTIONS (KLEŚAS)

LATENT DEPOSIT

REBIRTH PREPARATORY DISCIPLINE (KRIYĀ-YOGA) THINS AFFLICTIONS MEDITATION BURNS THE

attachment (rāga) / aversion (dveṣa) → clinging to life (abhiniveśa) afflictions (kleśas) → action →

Ignorance (avidyā) → ego-identification (asmitā)

fruition → rebirth preparatory discipline (kriyā-yoga) thins afflictions meditation burns the remaining seeds and makes

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• Ignorance (avidyā) → ego-identification (asmitā)
• attachment (rāga) / aversion (dveṣa) → clinging to life (abhiniveśa) afflictions (kleśas) → action → latent deposit →

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• fruition → rebirth preparatory discipline (kriyā-yoga) thins afflictions meditation burns the remaining seeds and makes discriminative insight possible
• Ignorance (avidyā) → ego-identification (asmitā)

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• attachment (rāga) / aversion (dveṣa) → clinging to life (abhiniveśa) afflictions (kleśas) → action → latent deposit →
• fruition → rebirth preparatory discipline (kriyā-yoga) thins afflictions meditation burns the remaining seeds and makes discriminative insight possible

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: attachment (rāga) / aversion (dveṣa) → clinging to life (abhiniveśa) afflictions (kleśas) → action → latent deposit → fruition → rebirth preparatory discipline (kriyā-yoga) thins afflictions meditation burns the remaining seeds and makes discriminative insight possible.

03

STAGE 03

EIGHT-LIMBED DISCIPLINE

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EIGHT-LIMBED DISCIPLINE (AṢṬĀNGA-YOGA) ETHICAL RESTRAINT

BREATH REGULATION

SENSE WITHDRAWAL

ABSORPTION FIRST FIVE PREPARE BODY, CONDUCT AND ATTENTION; FINAL

POSTURE IS ONE LIMB, NOT THE DEFINITION OR FINAL

sense withdrawal → concentration → meditation → absorption first five prepare body, conduct and attention

Eight-Limbed Discipline (Aṣṭāṅga-Yoga) ethical restraint → observance → posture → breath regulation

final three form integrated concentration trap: posture is one limb, not the definition or final

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• EIGHT-LIMBED DISCIPLINE (AṢṬĀNGA-YOGA) ethical restraint → observance → posture → breath regulation
• sense withdrawal → concentration → meditation → absorption first five prepare body, conduct and attention

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• final three form integrated concentration trap: posture is one limb, not the definition or final goal of Yoga
• EIGHT-LIMBED DISCIPLINE (AṢṬĀNGA-YOGA) ethical restraint → observance → posture → breath regulation

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• sense withdrawal → concentration → meditation → absorption first five prepare body, conduct and attention
• final three form integrated concentration trap: posture is one limb, not the definition or final goal of Yoga

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: posture is one limb, not the definition or final goal of Yoga.

04

STAGE 04

ABSORPTION LADDER

ABSORPTION LADDER

OBJECT-SUPPORTED ABSORPTION (SAMPRAJĀNĀTA-SAMĀDHI) GROSS REASONING

SUBTLE REFLECTION

I-AM-NESS TRUTH-BEARING INSIGHT

OBJECTLESS ABSORPTION

SEEDLESS ABSORPTION CLOUD-OF-VIRTUE ABSORPTION (DHARMAMEGHA-SAMĀDHI) ENDS AFFLICTION AND ACTION

→ objectless absorption → seedless absorption cloud-of-virtue absorption (dharmamegha-samādhī) ends affliction and action do

OBJECT-SUPPORTED ABSORPTION (SAMPRAJĀNĀTA-SAMĀDHI) gross reasoning → subtle reflection → joy → I-am-ness truth-bearing insight

not conflate the four YS 1.17 supports with the separate absorption taxonomy

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• OBJECT-SUPPORTED ABSORPTION (SAMPRAJĀNĀTA-SAMĀDHI) gross reasoning → subtle reflection → joy → I-am-ness truth-bearing insight
• → objectless absorption → seedless absorption cloud-of-virtue absorption (dharmamegha-samādhī) ends affliction and action do

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• not conflate the four YS 1.17 supports with the separate absorption taxonomy
• OBJECT-SUPPORTED ABSORPTION (SAMPRAJĀNĀTA-SAMĀDHI) gross reasoning → subtle reflection → joy → I-am-ness truth-bearing insight

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• → objectless absorption → seedless absorption cloud-of-virtue absorption (dharmamegha-samādhī) ends affliction and action do
• not conflate the four YS 1.17 supports with the separate absorption taxonomy

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OBJECT-SUPPORTED ABSORPTION (SAMPRAJĀNĀTA-SAMĀDHI) gross reasoning → subtle reflection → joy → I-am-ness truth-bearing insight → objectless absorption → seedless absorption cloud-of-virtue absorption (dharmamegha-samādhī) ends affliction and action do not conflate the four YS 1.17 supports with the separate absorption taxonomy.

05

STAGE 05

LORD AND DISCRIMINATIVE INSIGHT

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LORD (ĪŚVARA)

SPECIAL CONSCIOUS WITNESS, UNTOUCHED BY AFFLICTION OR ACTION DEDICATION

CONCENTRATION AID + TIMELESS TEACHER NOT THE MATERIAL CREATOR

DISCRIMINATIVE INSIGHT (VIVEKA-KHYĀTI)

YOGA IS THEISTIC SAMKHYA IN METHOD, WHILE LIBERATION REMAINS

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
LORD (ĪŚVARA) = SPECIAL CONSCIOUS WITNESS, UNTOUCHED BY AFFLICTION OR ACTION dedication to the Lord → concentration aid + timeless teacher not the material creator of	Nyaya and not a substitute for practice decisive knowledge = discriminative insight (viveka-khyāti) Yoga is theistic Samkhya in method, while liberation remains discriminative	LORD (ĪŚVARA) = SPECIAL CONSCIOUS WITNESS, UNTOUCHED BY AFFLICTION OR ACTION dedication to the Lord → concentration aid + timeless teacher not the material creator of
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Yoga is theistic Samkhya in method, while liberation remains discriminative.

06

STAGE 06

ISOLATION AND THE RELATION PROBLEM

ISOLATION AND THE RELATION PROBLEM

ISOLATION (KAIVALYA)

THE WITNESS ESTABLISHED IN ITS OWN NATURE REVERSE EVOLUTION

HOW CAN INACTIVE CONSCIOUSNESS RELATE TO INSENTIENT MIND?

REFLECTION AND MERE PROXIMITY PROTECT THE WITNESS FROM CHANGE

PROXIMITY NAMES THE RELATION MORE CLEARLY THAN IT EXPLAINS

DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
ISOLATION (KAIVALYA) = THE WITNESS ESTABLISHED IN ITS OWN NATURE reverse evolution returns constituent	reply: reflection and mere proximity protect the witness from change residual limit: proximity names the relation more clearly than it explains it	qualities to primordial material nature objection: how can inactive consciousness relate to insentient mind?
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DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: reply: reflection and mere proximity protect the witness from change residual limit: proximity names the relation more clearly than it explains it.

07

STAGE 07

PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS

EXPLAIN MECHANISM

CONNECT PRACTICE

EVALUATE MIND-FIELD

EIGHT LIMBS

ISOLATION USE THE EXACT QUESTION'S DOCTRINE; DISTINGUISH LORD, WITNESS

RIGOROUS PSYCHOLOGY AND PRAXIS, CONTESTED DUALIST RELATION

DEFINE → CLASSIFY → EXPLAIN MECHANISM → CONNECT PRACTICE → EVALUATE mind-field → modifications →

distinguish Lord, witness and mind add one named objection and the strongest Yoga reply qualified

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• DEFINE → CLASSIFY → EXPLAIN MECHANISM → CONNECT PRACTICE → EVALUATE mind-field → modifications → afflictions → eight
• distinguish Lord, witness and mind add one named objection and the strongest Yoga reply qualified verdict: rigorous psychology

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• DEFINE → CLASSIFY → EXPLAIN MECHANISM → CONNECT PRACTICE → EVALUATE mind-field → modifications → afflictions → eight
• distinguish Lord, witness and mind add one named objection and the strongest Yoga reply qualified verdict: rigorous psychology

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• DEFINE → CLASSIFY → EXPLAIN MECHANISM → CONNECT PRACTICE → EVALUATE mind-field → modifications → eight
• distinguish Lord, witness and mind add one named objection and the strongest Yoga reply qualified verdict: rigorous psychology

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DEFINE → CLASSIFY → EXPLAIN MECHANISM → CONNECT PRACTICE → EVALUATE mind-field → modifications → afflictions → eight limbs → absorption → isolation use the exact question's doctrine; distinguish Lord, witness and mind add one named objection and the strongest Yoga reply qualified verdict: rigorous psychology and praxis, contested dualist relation.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

OPTIONAL DEPTH 1 — YOGA AS THEISTIC SAMKHYA (SĒṢVARA-SAMKHYA)

OPTIONAL DEPTH 2 — RESTRAINT OF MENTAL MODIFICATIONS (CITTA-VṚTTI-NIRODHA)

FIVE MODIFICATIONS AND REAL TRANSFORMATION OF MIND

OPTIONAL DEPTH 3 — AFFLICTIONS (KLEŚAS), ACTION AND MORAL

THE CAUSAL THERAPY OF BONDAGE

OPTIONAL DEPTH 4 — MEDITATIVE ABSORPTION (SAMĀDHI)

OBJECT-SUPPORTED INSIGHT, SEEDLESS RESTRAINT AND CLASSIFICATION CONTROL

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

ADVANCED OBJECTION

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

• OPTIONAL DEPTH 1 — Yoga as Theistic Samkhya (sēṣvara-samkhya) and the Structure of Mind-field (citta)
• OPTIONAL DEPTH 2 — Restraint of mental modifications (citta-vṛtti-nirodha): Five Modifications and Real Transformation of Mind
• OPTIONAL DEPTH 3 — Afflictions (kleśas), Action and moral consequence (karma) and Aṣṭanga Yoga: The Causal Therapy of Bondage
• OPTIONAL DEPTH 4 — Meditative absorption (samādhī): Object-Supported Insight, Seedless Restraint and Classification Control

• OPTIONAL DEPTH 5 — Isolation (kaivalya) and Lord (īśvara): Isolation, Discernment and the Special Conscious witness (puruṣa)
• OPTIONAL DEPTH 6 — Inter-School Debates, Realism, Criticisms and UPSC Traps
• OPTIONAL DEPTH 7 — Advanced Ledgers, Comparative Positioning and the Graded Verdict
• OPTIONAL DEPTH 8 — PYQ Routing, Current Linkage and Complete Exam Deployment

• It is materially subtle and satta-v dominant, so it can reflect consciousness while remaining insentient in itself.
• Bondage occurs when borrowed luminosity is mistaken for intrinsic selfhood.
• The reflection model protects an unchanging Conscious witness (puruṣa); every transformation occurs on the mind-field (citta) side.
• Yet it presupposes an intelligible relation between radically different orders.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.